Handout 3-A: Time Audit Summary

Session 1 (predict) and Session 4 (review) · about 5 minutes to predict, about 20 minutes to review, plus about 5 minutes a day of tracking

A time audit shows the gap between where you think your time goes and where it really goes. You predict first, track honestly all week, then compare. The gap is the lesson, not a grade.

How to track. Each evening, fill in what you actually did, in blocks of about 30 minutes. Rough is fine. You can use the Iowa State Academic Success Center's Time Audit worksheet (Word file), a paper grid, or a notes app. No Word? Copy the layout onto paper: days across the top, hours down the side.

Fill in the **My prediction** column at the start of the week, before you track. Fill in the rest in Session 4. The gap is your log minus your prediction.

A week has 168 hours. Make "Other" whatever is left over (meals, commuting, errands, downtime), so each column adds up to 168.

Category	My prediction (hrs)	My log (hrs)	Gap	Surprise?
Classes / scheduled learning				
Study				
Sleep				
Work / caregiving / commitments				
Screens (non-academic)				
Other (meals, commuting, errands, downtime)				
Total	168	168	0	

My three biggest time leaks: 1. … 2. … 3. …

One thing that took longer than I expected: …

One time block that was better than I expected (protect this): …

Notes

- **Sensitivity.** If your week is dominated by work, caregiving, or commuting, that is not a leak. It's a constraint, and your plan has to be built around it.
- **Options.** A paper grid, a spreadsheet, a notes app, or a short voice memo each evening.
- **Low-tech floor.** A sheet of paper with a line for each day and a few words per block.

Worked example

Category	My prediction (hrs)	My log (hrs)	Gap	Surprise?
Classes / scheduled learning	12	12	0	No
Study	10	6	−4	Yes. I study much less than I think.
Sleep	56	49	−7	Yes. I sleep about 7 hours, not 8.
Work / caregiving / commitments	20	24	+4	A little. Shifts ran over.
Screens (non-academic)	7	16	+9	Yes. Most of it is between tasks.
Other (meals, commuting, errands, downtime)	63	61	−2	No
Total	168	168	0	

My three biggest time leaks: 1. Checking my phone between study blocks. 2. Starting study sessions 30 minutes late. 3. Scrolling in bed.

One thing that took longer than I expected: Errands on Saturday took 3 hours, not 1.

One time block that was better than I expected (protect this): Tuesday mornings before work gave me 90 quiet minutes.